Rice and **Wheat** are the staple food crops in Asia. China and India are the leading producers of rice in the world. Other important rice producing countries are **Myanmar, Japan, Bangladesh** and **Thailand**. Monsoon Asia is suitable for rice cultivation because of the abundant rainfall, fertile plains and availability of labour. **Thailand** is called the **Rice bowl** of South East Asia.



Banaue rice terrace: The Banaue rice terraces were built 2000 year ago by the Ifugaos people in the Philippines. It is located approximately about 1524 m above sea level.



Wheat is grown in the **temperate** regions of Asia. **Russia, India, China** and **Pakistan** are the leading producers of wheat in Asia. Millets like **Bajra, Jower, Ragi and Sorgham** are grown in the drier parts of Asia. These are widely cultivated in **India, Pakistan** and a few **gulf countries**. Apart from these, **pulses, spices** and **oil seeds** are also cultivated in various parts of Asia.

Jute and cotton are the important natural fibres cultivated in Asia. One third of the world's cotton is produced by Asia. The major cotton producing countries are **India**, **China, Russia** and **Kazakhstan**. **India, Pakistan, China** and **Bangladesh** are the leading producers of **jute**.

The tropical wet and dry climate is suitable for **sugarcane** cultivation in Asia. **India, Indonesia** and **Philippines** are the major producers of sugarcane. **Coffee, Tea, Rubber, Palm trees** and **Cocoa** are the important plantation crops. **India, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Vietnam, Malaysia** and **Indonesia** are important an producers of plantation crops. **Malaysia** and **Thailand** are the leading producers of **natural rubber.**

Dates are produced in west Asia, among the countries Iran is the largest producer of dates in the world.



Cocoa Tree

Fishing

Fishing is an important economic activity in Asia. It is prevalent in open seas as well as inland water bodies. **China** and **Japan** are the leading fishing nations. In **Cambodia, Tonle Sap** lake is one of the world's richest sources of fresh water fishing. Bay of Bengal is the major fishing ground for India, Sri Lanka, Myanmar and Bangladesh. Fishing is the mainstay of the national economy in **Maldives**. **Pearl fishing** (Bahrein) is popular in the eastern **coast of Arabia**.

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